

This site, surrounded by a wall made of very large boulders (the largest are 1.5x3 m in size!), fits the elliptical outline of the ridge. Remains of short walls, related to the main one, evidence to structures that were once attached to it.

Only the southern part of the enclosure was preserved, whereas the northern one disappeared. Very few shards were found.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 129: 19 – 18/79/1

Khirbet es-Samrah (Guérin: Kh. es-Somera)

Israel grid: 1970 1890

UTM grid: 7351 5741

Elevation: 55 m a.s.l., 8 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 30 dunams (7.5 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Colluvial – Alluvial;

quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 28

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), passes by site

Visibility: 3

May 19, 1982; Mar. 10, 1990; Apr. 1, 1993; 77 shards

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A large ruin on the Buqei'ah, near Wadi el-Fau. It is situated northeast of the Samrah junction, where the 'Shai ascent' road leaves the Beqa'ot – Meholah one.

The ruin is situated between two wadis that descend westward. The remains of 70 or more units, with houses and courtyards, are arranged on two ridges running from east to west. Each such unit contains a central structure with a series of rooms, arranged around one or more courtyards, and a cistern. The basic building is of good quality, made of large, hewn, smoothen stones.

Architectural special items (columns, worked stones, decorations and columns) were also discovered. An apparently later building stage, where small field stones are used, appears on top of the first stage structures. In the southern part of the site are three burial caves with a hall (*dromos*) and a hewn entrance. Next to the road a complete "villa" *in situ* has survived (fig. 288), with two water channels (*aqueducts*). The shards prior to the Roman period were collected only in the northern site, while later ones (Roman onwards) are scattered all over.

In the wadi to the north of the site are dams.

Pottery: MBA I – 3%; IrA II – 2%; Per – 2%; Hel – 10%; ER – 10%; LR – 13%; Byz – 30%; EM – 10%; MA – 20%.

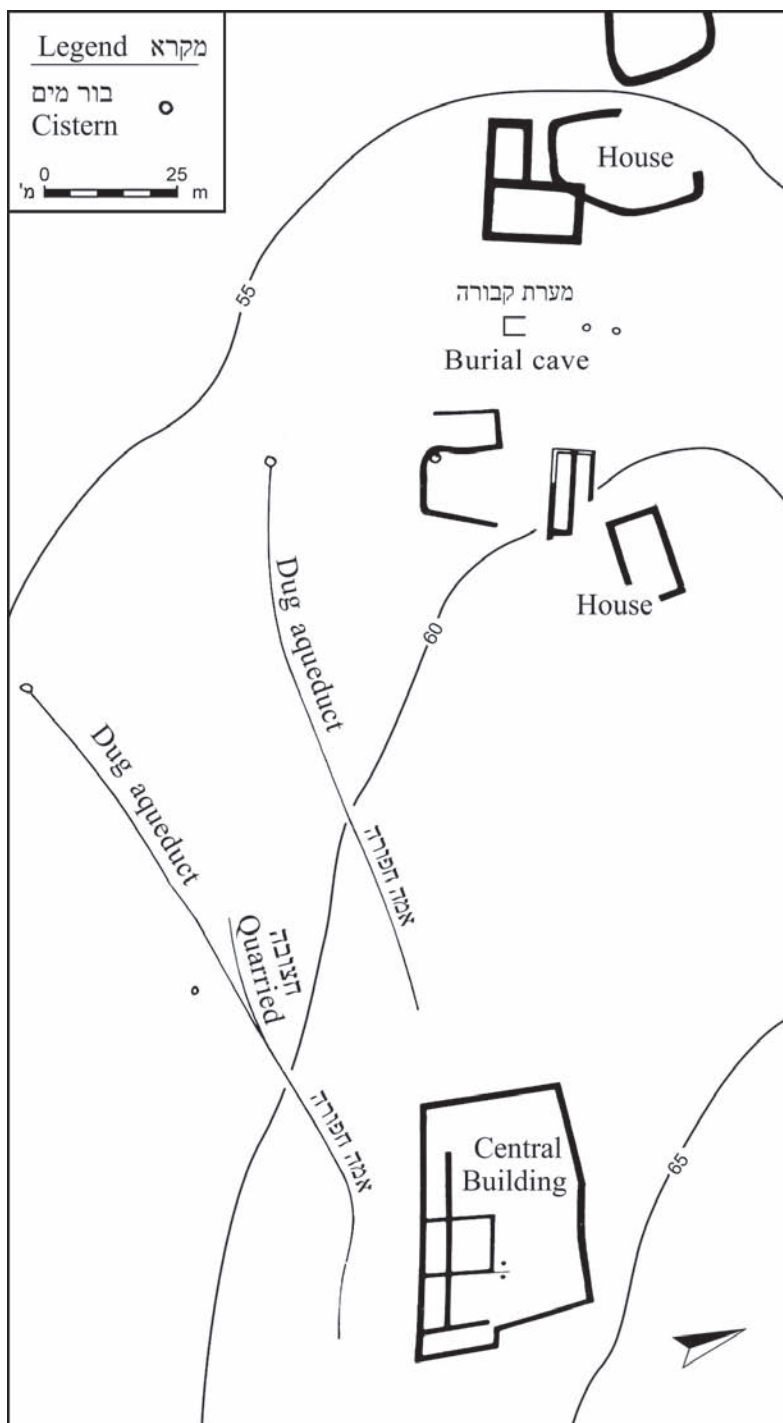
Coin find: 11 coins from LR to MA; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.

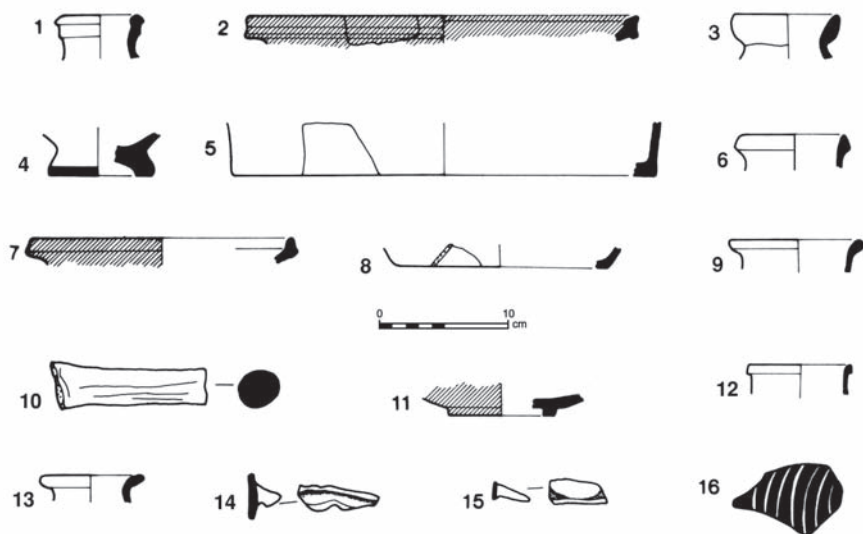
Bibliography: SWP II, 240; Guérin 1969 (IV), 226; (V), 175.



287. Bird's eye view of the large site of Kh. es-Samrah on the northern Buqeī'ah, looking northeast. The main road (bottom) leads to Meholah (left) and to Wadi el-Far'ah (right). Upward and to the right is the 'Shai ascent' road. The site extends over both sides of the latter (see plan). In the ravine at left is a series of dams.



288. Plan of the southern part of Kh. es-Samrah. In this area scattered solitary houses, cisterns and many hewn installations were discerned.



289. Pottery from Kh. es-Samrah: 1. Jar, dk gray, Byz; 2. Bowl, red slip and burnish, ER; 3. Jar, dk gray, Hel; 4. Bowl base, gray, bl and wh slip, MA; 5. Basin, br, LR; 6. Jar, lt br, Per; 7. Jar, red burnish, ER; 8. Jar base, lt, MBA I; 9. Jar, dk gray, Byz; 10. Jar handle, lt, Hell; 11. Bowl base, Sigillata, red burnished, ER; 12-13. Jar, br, Roman; 14-15. Ledge handles, lt, MBA I; 16. Dec, wh on bl, EM.



Site 130: 19 – 18/36/1

Umm el-Hasan

Israel grid: 1935 1860

UTM grid: 7316 5730

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa'ot
junction (C20), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

Mar. 31, 1982; Mar. 17, 1990; 29
shards

A large courtyard in a small ravine, on a slope on the northern Buqe'ah.

The irregular, rectangular like

enclosure is 26x48 m in measurements, surrounded by a 1.5 m wide wall made of large field stones. In the western wall a built entrance 1

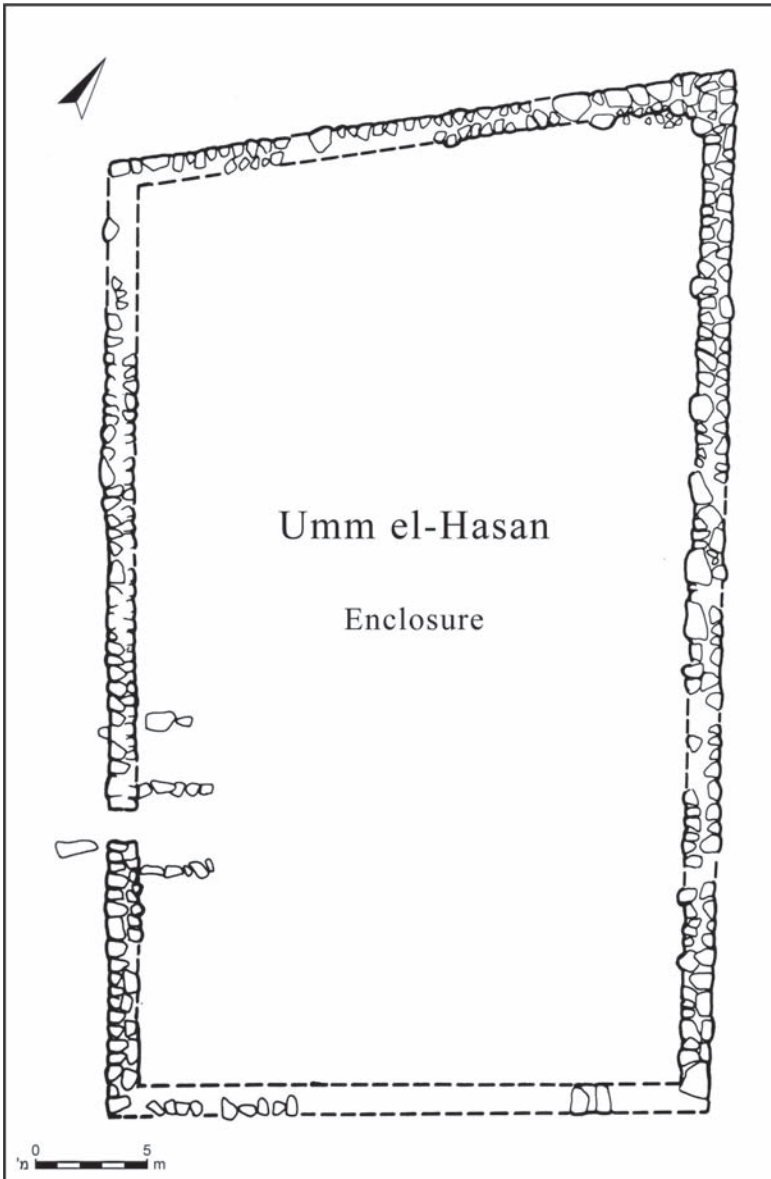
m wide was discerned, with few remains of inner walls.

This structure, of agricultural character, is one of a group of similar enclosures dated to the Byzan-

tine Period. They were used presumably as animal pens.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



290. Plan of the Umm el-Hasan courtyard on the Buqe'ah. This structure, typical to the Desert Fringes, was used for animal (cattle?) husbandry.

Site 131: 19 – 18/15/1

Khirbet 'Atuf (on SWP map and Guérin: Kh. A'thouf)

Israel grid: 1914 1856

UTM grid: 7296 5724

Elevation: 130 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 20 dunams (5 acres)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 22

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa'ot
junction (C20), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Mar. 9, 1982; May 30, 1993; May 5,
2006; Jul. 7, 2006; 66 shards

* * *

A large site on the southern edge of the Buqe'ah, at the foot of Jebel el Tammun. A good view of the

Buqe'ah is seen from the place, and a dirt road from Beqa'ot to Tammun passes nearby.



291. The large Kh. 'Atuf from the air, looking west. The Beqa'ot - Tammun road is in the center, with the site (dated to the Roman-Byzantine Periods onwards) at left, on the low slope of Jebel Tammun. To the right of the road is the "pools" area, possibly used for special crops (rice, sugar cane?). 1996.

The site is a medium sized, Medieval ruined village atop a more ancient (Iron Age to Byzantine Period) ruin, with several Bedouin families now. The 60 ruined structures *in situ*, with some roofing preserved, are laid upon ancient foundations. The foundations and abandonment dates of these houses, most of which are of the house courtyard type, are unclear. They are arranged in groups or complexes. There is what seems to be a main street, which leads in eastwest direction. Many cisterns, caves and other hewn places are discerned. East of the village on the plain there is an area rich in shards with some ruined buildings.

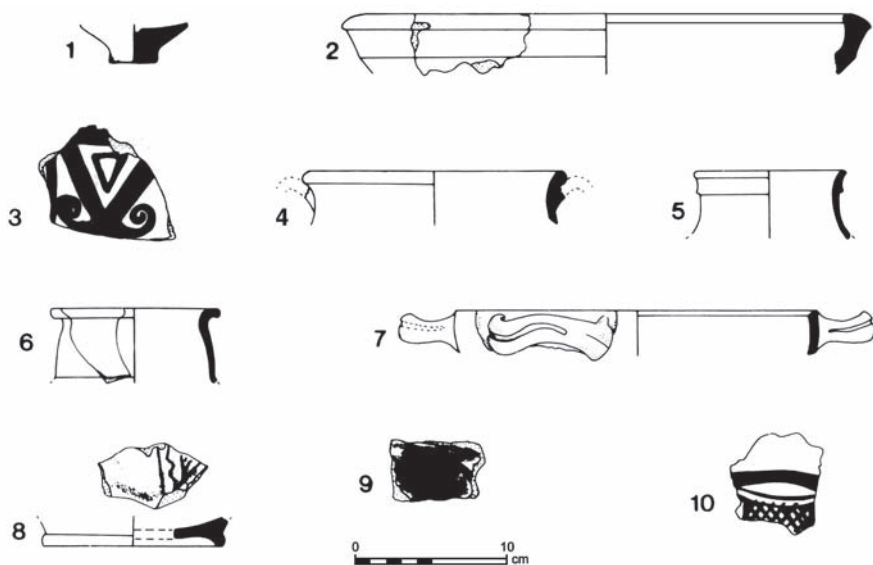
North of the Beqa'ot – Tammun road there is a large agricultural section, some 50 dunams in area, with 70-90 leveled “pools”, surrounded by low earthen ramps. They appear to be built for some special agricultural crop – perhaps rice, sugar cane or fish growing. This exceptional phenomenon is without parallel in the Manasseh Hill Country.

Pottery: IrA II-III – 5%; Byz – 50%; EM – 30%; MA – 15%.

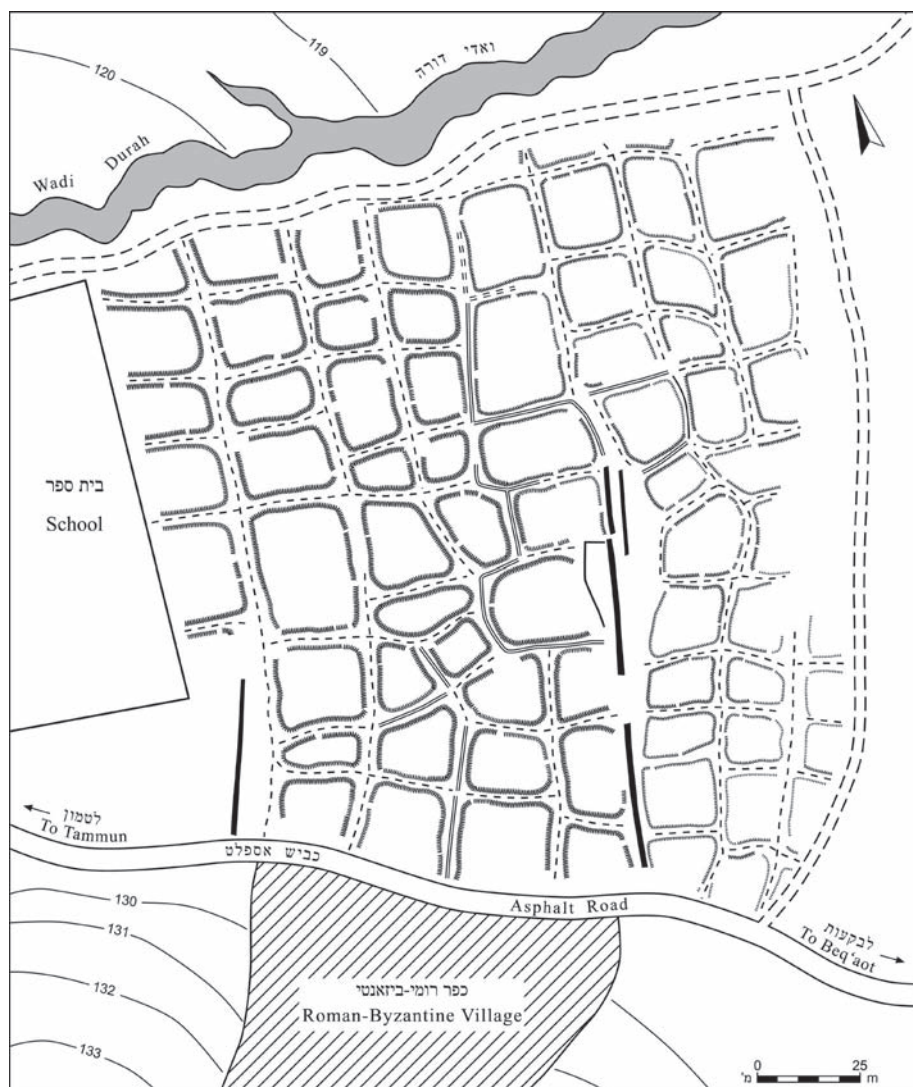
Special find: two wedge dec bowls.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 135.

Bibliography: SWP II, 237; Guérin 1969 (IV), 255-256.



292. Pottery from Kh. 'Atuf: 1. Juglet base, lt, EM; 2. Bowl, br, IrA II; 3. Dec shard, violet on wh, MA; 4-7. Jars, jugs and 'frying pan', lt br, Byz; 8. Bowl base, yellow glaze, MA; 9-10. Painted shards, MA.



293. Plan of the "pools" area in Kh. 'Atuf, 2006.

Site 132: 19 – 18/34/1

Khirbet es-Sefireh (on PEF map: Kh. es-Sefeirah)

Israel grid: 1933 1843

UTM grid: 7316 5712

Elevation: 55 m a.s.l., 3 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: farm and structure

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: valley

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Tammun – Beqa'ot
junction (C20), passes by site

Visibility: 4

May 13, 1982; Mar. 1, 1990; 72
shards

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A site on a low hillock in the center of the Buqe'ah, surrounded by fields and located about 1 km north – northeast of Moshav Beqa'ot.

A rectangular courtyard 11x22 m in size is the center of the place. The surrounding wall is of two rows of

hewn stones. In the northern wall a protrusion indicates the possible gate, with two dividing walls nearby. Inside the yard (south) is an elliptical structure, 10 m in diameter, built of field stones. This may represent a later (Medieval?) stage.



294. Remains at Kh. es-Sefireh, looking south.

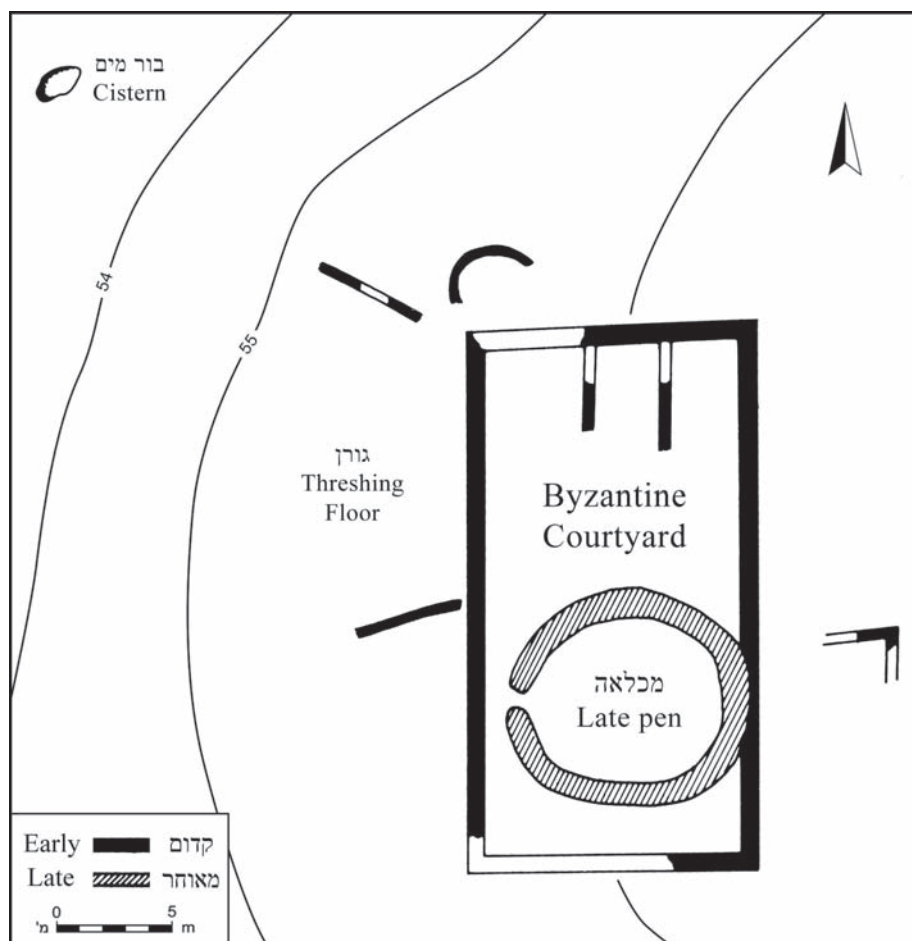
West and south of the structure are two cisterns; the southern one includes a hewn, stone pillar *in situ*. Next and west to the yard a threshing floor was found. More walls are scattered on the hillock.

Pottery: IrA III – 30%; Byz – 60%;

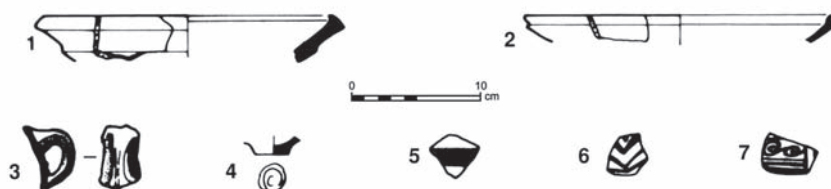
MA – 10%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 143. They found a “solitary structure on a low hill-top”.

Bibliography: SWP II, 240.



295. Plan of Kh. es-Sefireh. Note the courtyard and the threshing floor.



296. Pottery from Kh. es-Sefireh: 1. Bowl, lt br, IrA III; 2. Bowl, br, Byz; 3. Jar handle, dk gray, Byz; 4. Juglet base, pk, Byz; 5-7. Decorated shards, violet on wh, MA.



Site 133: 19 – 18/44/1

Khirbet Umm el-Qatan (on SWP map: Kh. Umm el Kotn)

Israel grid: 1947 1841

UTM grid: 7329 5710

Elevation: 50 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: small ruin and farm

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: hilltop and valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium, near agricultural

soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 6

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu
(C23), passes by site

Visibility: 6

May 13, 1982; Jan. 17, 1990; Apr.
10, 1993; Jan. 13, 2006; 106 shards

A fortified site on an isolated hilltop in the center of the Buqei'ah, with a fine view to its eastern section. The Mehola – Wadi Far'ah asphalt road ('Alon road') passes to the west of the site, with the junction to Moshav Ro'i nearby.

The site is approached from the north. A fortified structure, about 44x48 m in size, is arranged around a 20x30 m square yard in its center. This is surrounded on all sides by series of rooms – long halls and

square units – of irregular dimensions and plan. The main entrance was seemingly on the western side, where the most massive architecture is discerned. From the main body "wings" or towers protrude to the north, the south and the west; some of them contains inner divisions. Three cisterns are inside the fort, with ten more scattered upon the hill (figs. 298, 300).

The fort seems to be built in at least two chronological stages.

The first one (the fortified structure) is of large boulders, without mortar and with several monoliths incorporated in the building (fig. 298– black). On top of this stage a later one is apparent. The stones, taken from the first building, were secondarily used for small, irregular courtyards and structures. The difference between the two stages is striking (fig. 298 – gray).

The considerable amount of Iron Age shards may identify the first structure with this period. The later stage, judging by the architecture, may be dated to Middle Ages.

The 10 cistern openings on the

hill, at distances of 10 to 50 m from one another, are large hewn openings.

There is a similarity in plan between Kh. Umm el-Qatan and Jellamet Wustah (Khallet Kalles) – (Zertal 2004, Site no. 152). The resemblance is in building design and plan. Both, apparently dated to Iron Age III (Assyrian period), have been functioning as fortresses or administrative structures.

Pottery: IrA III – 70%; Byz – 15%; EM – 5%; MA – 10%.

Coin find: Four coins from the MA; see appendix.



297. Aerial photo of the fortress site at Kh. Umm el-Qatan. The site is located on a low, rocky hill near an important junction in the heart of the Buqe'ah. The central structure resembles fortified sites (from the end of the Iron Age) found on Jebel Hureish and near Sanur Valley.

Special find: Iron Age arrowhead.

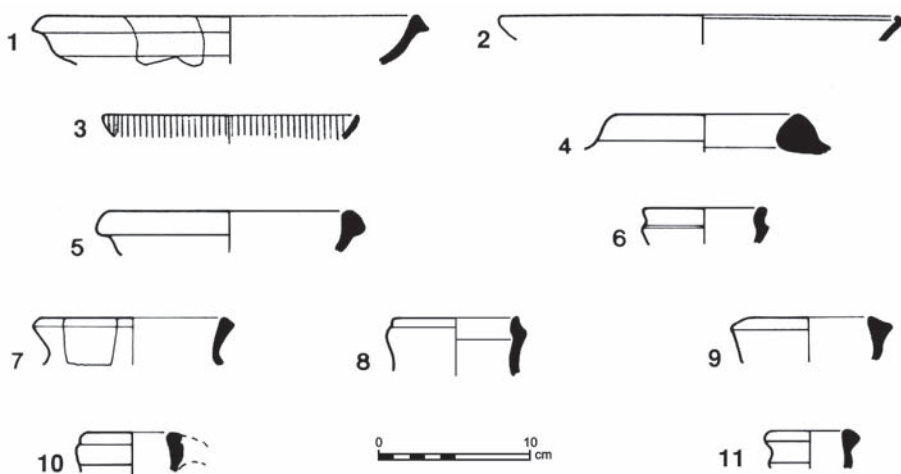
Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 144. They found “a

ruin on a hilltop. In the area of the ruin are structural remains.”

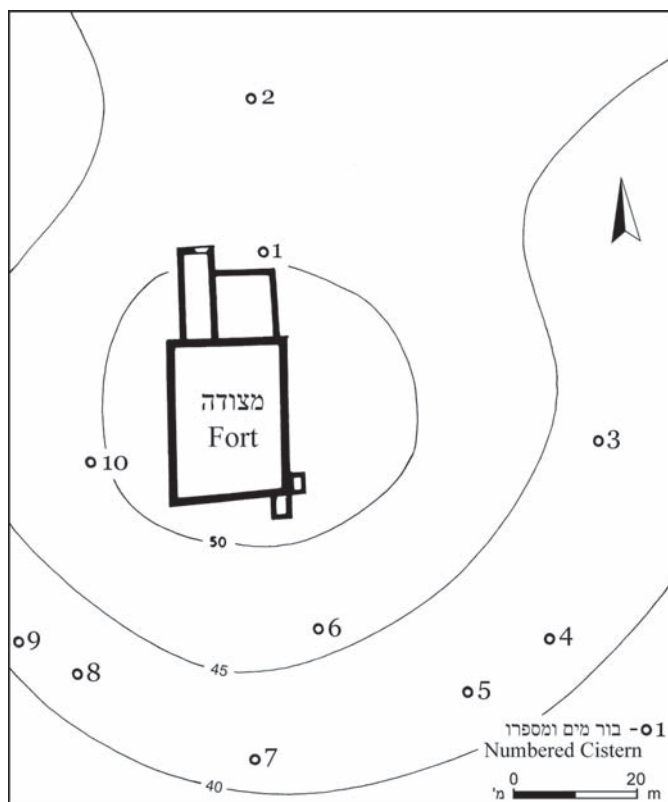
Bibliography: SWP II, 241.



298. The plan of Kh. Umm el-Qatan . Note the original structure and the additions from later periods (Byzantine Period to Middle Ages) on top of it.



299. Pottery from Kh. Umm el-Qatan: 1. Bowl, br/bl, IrA III; 2. Bowl, gray, Byz; 3. Bowl, green glaze, MA; 4. Jar/HM jar, dk br, IrA II-III; 5. Bowl, br/gray, IrA III; 6. Jug, br, Byz; 7. Jar, dk gray, IrA III; 8-11. Jars and jugs, Byz and EM.



300. Plan of the hill, with the fort of Umm el-Qatan and the installations (numbered).

Site 134: 19 – 18/64/3

Ro'i (1)

Israel grid: 1964 1846

UTM grid: 7356 5713

Elevation: 60 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and structures

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest
soil; quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu
(C23), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

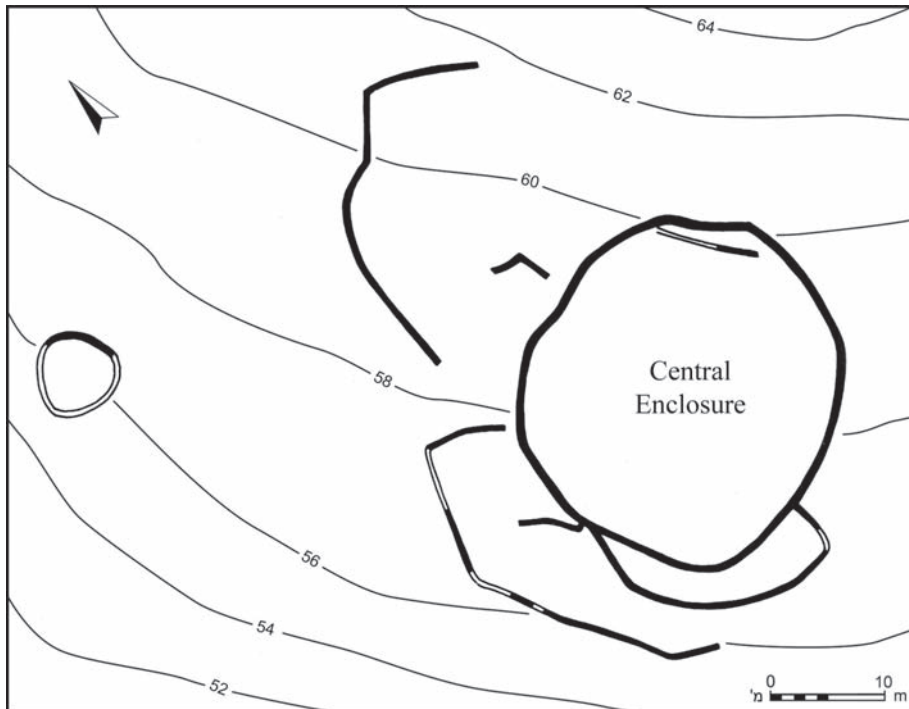
Jan. 27, 1992; Jul. 7, 2006; 34 shards
and six flint items

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A site on the southern slope of Twel
edh Dhyiab range, in the northeast-
ern Buqei'ah. It is built near a small
wadi descending from the summit

into the valley.

The oval, empty enclosure about
35 m in diameter, is surrounded by
a wall of large, unhewn stones. To



301. Plan of Ro'i (1). The walls around the enclosure were apparently used for dwelling houses.

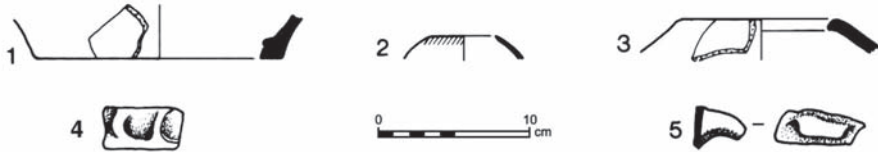
the south and west, and adjacent to the enclosure, various structures are discerned built of walls 40-60 cm wide. There was a medium sized shard scatter.

This site is a typical Chalcolithic Period enclosure in the Manasseh

fringes.

Pottery and flint: Chal – 100%; see flint appendix. In a later visit (Jul. 7, 2006) a possible IrA I-II shards were collected.

Previous surveys: none.



302. Selection of pottery from the Chalcolithic Period site of Ro'i (1), all from this period: 1. 'V shaped' bowl base, dk; 2-3. HM jars, br; 4. Rope dec; 5. Wide strip handle, dk.



Site 135: 19 – 18/64/1

Twel edh-Dhyab (on PEF map as well)

Israel grid: 1967 1848

UTM grid: 7349 5719

Elevation: 156 m a.s.l., 110 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 7 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1 km distant

Visibility: 8

May 13, 1982; May 11, 1990; 14 shards

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A structure on a high summit in the northern Buqeï'ah. West of this range, in a valley, passes the C23 road to Meholah, with another asphalt road to Hemdat extending eastwards.

On the summit is a structure about 6x10 m in size, built

of slightly hewn, large boulders 40x60x60 cm in average. Due to advanced destruction, its plan is hardly discerned. It seems to be a watch tower to control the central Buqeï'ah and the roads nearby. Few shards were found.

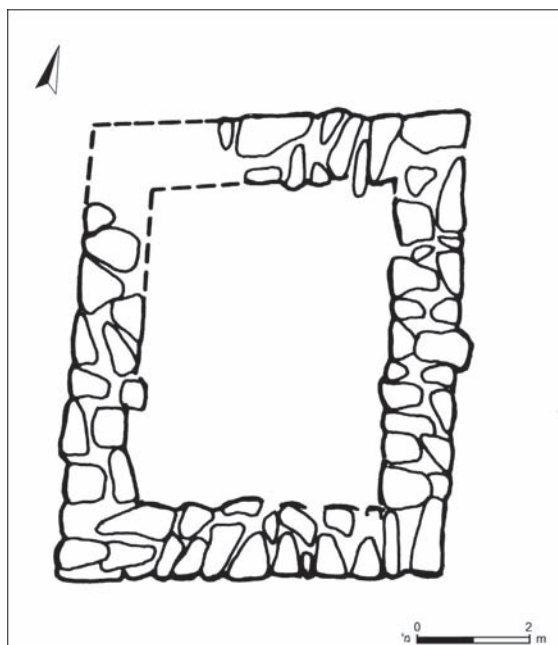
Pottery: Hel – 50%; Byz – 50%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 145.

Bibliography: appears on SWP map with the note (R) signifying ruin; no description is given.



303. The structure at Twel edh-Dhyab, viewed from the east.



304. Plan of the structure at Twel edh-Dhyab.

Site 136: 19 – 18/64/2

Khirbet el-Hadidiyyeh

Israel grid: 1967 1841

UTM grid: 7361 5712

Elevation: 40 m a.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: farm

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: low ridge in valley

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: on ridge – none; in valley – field crops

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

Apr. 27, 1990; May 11, 1990; 95 shards

An agricultural complex on a low ridge in the northern Buqeī'ah, 0.4 km northeast of the center of Moshav Ro'i.

The complex is comprised of four parts:

1. The central structure (the first stage), 18x27 m in size, is built of large, hewn stones. It includes at least two large rooms, with a courtyard in the eastern part. The walls are 1 m wide. On top of it there is a later pen with small, additional structures. Apparently in this later stage the ancient structure was unused.

2. West of the complex is a long and narrow structure (6X9 m), including two stages as well. It is built around the opening of a large cave.

3. A large cistern, with a built *aq-*

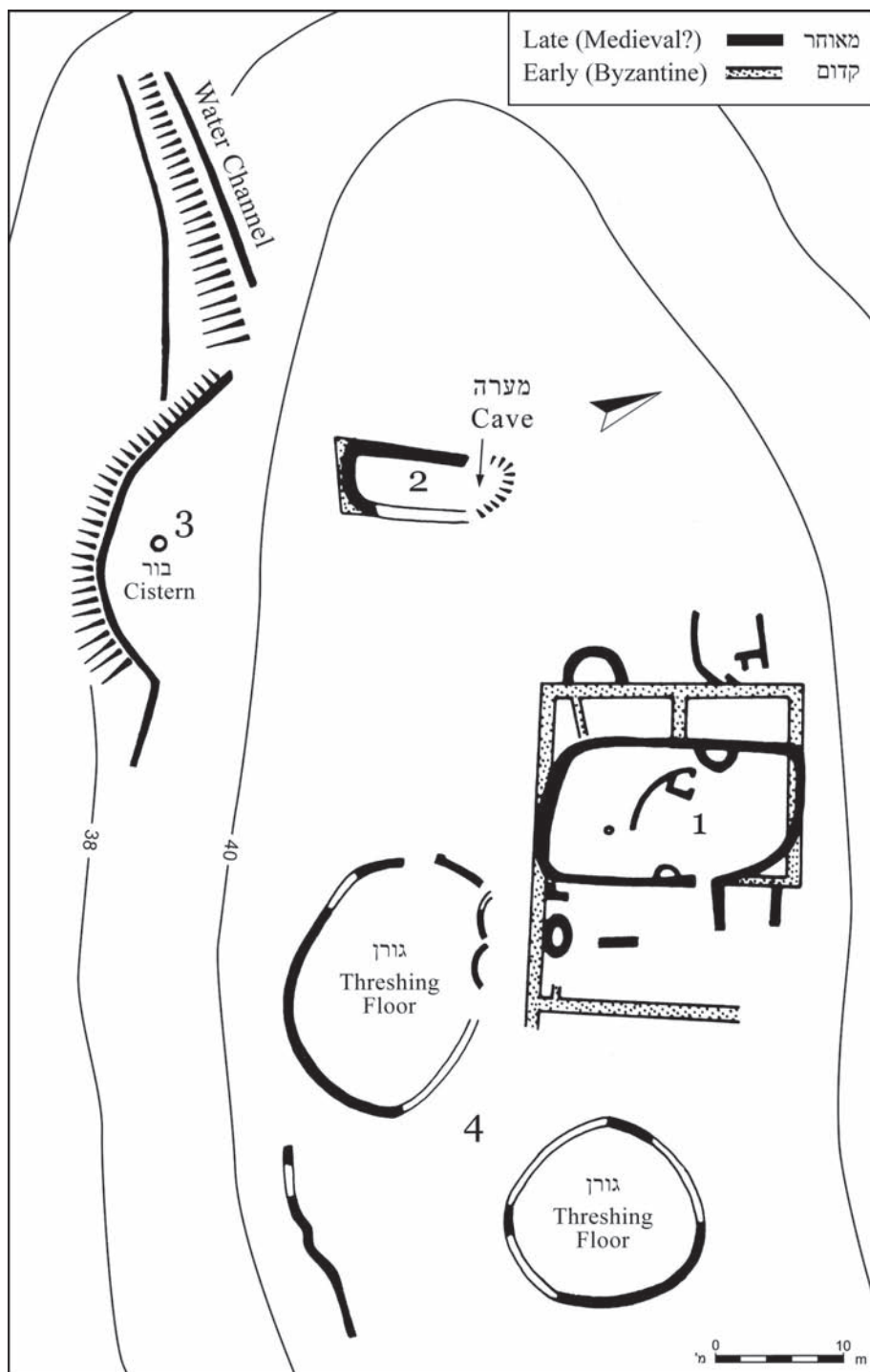
ueduct leading to it, is located some 36 m southwest of no. 1.

4. Two round and oval threshing floors, each surrounded by a low wall, are situated south and east of the central structure.

The architecture has two stages: the first and massive one was presumably Byzantine, while the later one is probably medieval. The threshing floors evince the crucial role of cereal agriculture in the economy of the region.

Pottery: Byz – 50%; EM – 30%; MA – 20%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 151. They mention “a solitary, rectangular structure on a ridge edge, with a few Byzantine Period shards nearby”.



305. Plan of Kh. el-Hadidiyyeh with its stages.

Site 137: 19 – 18/74/1

el-Mashkakah

Israel grid: 1975 1849

UTM grid: 7356 5716

Elevation: 60 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin and shard scatter

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 8 km distantNearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu
(C23), 2 km distant

Visibility: 3

Mar. 2, 1990; 22 shards

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A site in a small valley in the northern Buqe'ah, between Twel edh-Dhyab and Mufyeh Range.

In the center of the valley is an elevated, rocky area, on which there are cleared stones and concentrations of pottery. It seems to be the

remains of dismantled structures, or camp remains from the Iron Age. The pottery find includes many body shards but few rims.

Pottery: IrA II – 50%; IrA III – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 138: 19 – 18/84/1

Khallet Makhul

Israel grid: 1984 1847

UTM grid: 7375 5718

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 1.5 dunam (0.38 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Uyun Hilu, no. 88), 8 km distant

Nearest road: Beqa'ot – Tel el-Hilu
(C23), 3 km distant

Visibility: 2

Feb. 23, 1990; 40 shards

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An enclosure and structures on the southern edge of a small valley, between Peles In the north and Kh. Mufyeh in the south. The road to

Hemdat passes through this valley.

The elliptical enclosure, 35-40 m in length and 18 m in width, is built of large stones laid in a row.